AA-S-81b
October 9, 1962

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-S-81a
December 31, 1941

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SAFE, OFFICE, FIRE RESISTANT, BURGLARY PROTECTION

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers office safes which afford protection against fire for the length of time indicated in 1.2.1 and afford a limited degree of protection against burglarious attack in which explosives or oxy-fuel-gas-cutting torches are not employed. (See 6.1.) *The safes are not intended for storage of classified records or items of any great monetary value.*

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Classes, styles, and sizes.* The safes shall be of the following classes, styles, and sizes, as specified:

Class A.—4 hours fire resistant.
Class B.—2 hours fire resistant.
Class C.—1 hour fire resistant.
Style 1.—Non-receding doors.
Style 2.—Receding doors.

1.2.1.1 *Sizes.* Safes shall be of the sizes specified in the invitation for bids. Various commercially available sizes are listed in 6.4. These sizes are given for guidance and information purposes only.

1.2.2 *Interior arrangement.* Safes shall have an interior arrangement as specified in the invitation for bids.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-490—Cleaning Methods and Pretreatment of Ferrous Surfaces for Organic Coatings.
UU-P-268—Paper, Kraft, Wrapping
PPP-T-60—Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof for Packaging and Sealing.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)
Fed. Std. No. 595—Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents,

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U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activties outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activties may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-C-104—Crates, Wood; Lumber and Plywood Sheathed, Nailed and Bolted.

MIL-C-132—Crates, Open, Wood; Maximum Capacity 2500 Pounds.

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods Of.

MIL-V-13811—Varnish, Waterproofing, Electrical Ignition.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications.** The following publications of the issues in effect on date of invitations for bids, form a part of this specification.

Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. Standards:

72—Standard for Fire Resistance Classification of Record Protection Equipment.

140—Standard for Relocking Devices.

720—Standard for Tamper-Resistant Doors (Class T-20).

768—Standard for Combination Locks.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, 11, Illinois; 161 Sixth Avenue, New York 13, New York; or 1655 Scott Boulevard, Santa Clara, California.)

Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies may be addressed to the Uniform Freight Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Illinois.)

National Motor Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies may be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc. 1616 P Street, NW., Washington, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Preproduction sample.** Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, before production is commenced, a sample of the finished safe shall be submitted or made ready for approval by the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection. The purpose of testing the preproduction sample is to determine whether the item manufactured by the contractor has the performance characteristics required by the specifications. It is not the purpose of preproduction sample inspection to determine compliance with the detailed requirements of the specification and approval of the preproduction sample does not constitute approval of the item as complying with the detailed requirements of the specification, inasmuch as each production item must comply with the detailed requirements of the specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities to be used for manufacture of the production item.

3.2 **Materials.** The material shall conform to the applicable specifications and to the requirements specified herein. Where ma-

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terials are not definitely specified, the material shall be of the quality normally used in the manufacturer's commercial practice.

3.3 Construction. The safes shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product, except for any design modifications and additional requirements specified herein. All safes of the same classifications furnished under one contract shall be identical. The safes shall provide the fire protection specified in 3.4; and shall have tamper resistant doors as specified in 3.5.1; a combination lock as specified in 3.5.2; a relocking device as specified in 3.5.3; and casters, wheels, or a solid metal base as specified in 3.5.4.

3.4 Fire resistance, impact, and explosion-hazard certification. The bidder shall certify with his bid that the insulating material and fire resistance of the safes offered meet the requirements of the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. Standard UL 72 for classes A, B, and C safes, as applicable. The Underwriters' class A, B, or C safe label, as applicable, affixed to each cabinet will be accepted as evidence of compliance with the requirements.

3.5 Details of components. The bidder shall certify with his bid that the component meets the requirements of the applicable Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. Standard. The applicable Underwriters' label affixed to each component will be accepted as evidence of compliance with the requirements.

3.5.1 *Tamper-resistant doors.* The tamper-resistant doors shall conform to Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. Standard UL 720, class T-20.

3.5.2 *Combination lock.* The combination lock shall conform to Underwriters' Laboratories Inc. Standard UL 768, group II. The combination locks shall be of the hand-change or key-change type as specified. (See 6.2.) Instructions for changing combinations shall be supplied with each lock.

3.5.3 *Relocking device.* The relocking device shall conform to Underwriters' Laboratories Standard Subject 140.

3.5.4 *Wheels, casters, and solid-metal base.* Each safe shall be provided with wheels, casters, or a solid-metal base as specified in the invitation for bids. The casters and wheels shall be secured to the safe by means of screws or bolts in a manner to permit replacement from the outside; and shall not jam, bind, or become deformed when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.5.5 *Face hardware.* The face hardware shall be satin-finished anodized aluminum; stainless steel; or brushed chromium or electroless nickel coating on steel, die-cast zinc, bronze, or brass.

3.6 Finish. All interior and exterior steel surfaces of the safe, except finished hardware, shall be prepared for painting in accordance with 3.6.1. All surfaces shall be coated with material conforming to the requirements of 3.6.2. The minimum total finished film thickness of the coating shall be not less than 1 mil. The finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform exposed surfaces without runs, wrinkles, grit, areas of thin film or no film and separation of color. Special attention shall be given to bases and to the interior to insure that all surfaces are adequately protected against rust.

3.6.1 *Cleaning.* All metal surfaces, except finished hardware, shall be cleaned and surface preparation processed in accordance with any of the grades or types specified in TT-C-490.

3.6.2 *Organic coating.* Coating shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice, except that the color shall be as specified in 3.6.3. The coating shall be applied and cured in accordance with the supplier's directions. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, the coating shall show no evidence of cracking, flaking or loss of adhesion.

3.6.3 *Color of finish.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, the color

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of finish shall be gray, Color No. 26134 of Fed. Std. No. 595. Sample panels of the standard color of finish are obtainable, without charge, from the Business Service Center, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C., or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.

3.7 **Weight.** The weight of the safe, with interior equipment, shall not exceed 250 pounds per square foot of base area. The safe base area shall be the same as the top. The weight shall be permanently marked on the front of the safe in letters not less than 1/2 inch in height so as to be legible from the front. The weight indicated on the label shall be not less than the actual weight of the cabinet.

3.8 **Lubrication.** All moving parts shall have a permanent lubricant suitable to a wide range of temperatures which might be encountered in the United States and its possessions.

3.9 **Identification marking.** Identification marking shall be as hereinafter specified. (See 6.2.)

3.9.1 *Civil agencies.* Each safe shall be permanently marked on the inside in a plain and legible manner with the specification number, the Federal stock number, the date of manufacture (month and year), the contractor's name or trademark, and the contract order number, so that the source of supply may be readily determined.

3.9.2 *Military agencies.* Each safe shall be marked in accordance with the requirements for unit items of MIL-STD-130.

3.9.3 *Protection marking.* Each safe shall have a metal plate specifying the fire-resistance classification, tamper-resistant door classification, combination lock group and relocking device. Characters shall be easily read and not less than 1/8 inch in height.

3.10 **Workmanship.** The workmanship shall be of a quality to produce a serviceable and neat item of office furniture, built to withstand daily usage. The safe shall be free of any defects which might affect its durability, serviceability, or appearance.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Inspection responsibility.** The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Preproduction sample inspection.** When a preproduction sample is required, the preproduction sample shall be examined in accordance with the defects specified in 4.3.2.1, and tested as specified in 4.4.1.

4.3 **Sampling for inspection and acceptance.** Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 *Component and material inspection.* In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or if none in accordance with this specification.

4.3.2 *End item inspection.*

4.3.2.1 *Visual examination.* Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects set forth below and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) in

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4.3.2.3. The lot sizes shall be expressed in units of safes for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit selected for examination shall be one safe of same class, style and size as applicable.

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish	Wrong type or color		X
	Color separation or stains clearly noticeable		X
	Not smooth or uniform		X
	Foreign matter embedded in finish		X
	Bare spots or areas of visibly thin coating		X
	Tacky, soft runs, or sags		X
	Orange peel, scratch, or abrasion, clearly noticeable		X
	Indication of rust under finish, or evidence of poor adhesion	X	X
	Flaky, blistered, or peeling		X
Construction and workmanship	Any departure from specification requirements, or from the approved sample	X	
	Interior arrangement of safe not as specified		X
	Any part missing, broken, split, fractured, cracked, or punctured	X	
	Any part malformed, dented, buckled, warped, bent out of shape, or otherwise damaged	X	
	Any part misaligned, mispositioned, or in wrong location, affecting serviceability	X	
	Sharp edge or projection that may cause injury	X	
	Casters and wheels not secured to safe	X	
	Casters and wheels not replaceable type as specified	X	
	Doors do not fit or operate properly within binding or alignment of outside	X	
	Combination lock binds or does not function as specified	X	
	Any screw or bolt missing from caster and wheels (as applicable)	X	
	Combination lock not of hand-change or key-change type (as applicable)	X	
	Safe not equipped with relocking device as specified	X	
Identification markings	Metal nameplate information omitted, illegible, or not as specified	X	
	Height of letters not as specified		X
Instruction for combination lock	Instruction for changing combination lock omitted, or incomplete	X	

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4.3.2.2 *Dimensional examination.* Inspection shall be made of safes for compliance with dimensions specified. Any deviation from specified dimensions shall constitute a defect.

4.3.2.3 *Inspection levels and AQL's.* The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units, and inspection levels shall be as follows:

For examination in	Inspection Levels	AQL's	
		Major	*Totals*
4.3.2.1	II	4.0	6.5
4.3.2.2 (one class)	L 4	—	4.0

4.3.2.4 *Testing of end item.* The contractor shall perform a test in accordance with 4.4.1 on one safe from each inspection lot with no indication of failure.

4.3.3 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination will be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects will be scored as specified below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be L7 and the acceptable quality level shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Preservation	Not provided with humidity indicator or an activated desiccant.
	Desiccant not in accordance with formula II of MIL-P-116.
	Desiccant not distributed evenly throughout the interior of safe.
Lubrication	All hinges, rollers, casters, wheels, exterior locks, door handles, locking bolts, locking and dialing mechanism not lubricated to full capacity.
Packaging	All drawers, adjustable shelves, vertical partitions, and other interior components not secured in position, cushioned, or wrapped to prevent movement in transit.
Packaging (Cont'd.)	Drawer locks not provided with keys, drawers not locked or their respective keys not placed in kraft envelope and attached to drawers by tape.
	Instructions for the opening and changing of the combination lock not packaged method I C-1 of MIL-P-116 and secured to door of safe with tape specified.
	All openings into the safe, including the dial mechanism, not sealed with tape specified or exposed surfaces of tape not coated with varnish as specified.
	Each safe top and four sides not wrapped with kraft paper or the wrap not secured with tape specified.
Packing	Not packed in a snug fitting container conforming to type, class and style as specified in MIL-C-104.
	Not anchored, blocked, and braced in accordance with appendix of container specification.
	Safes provided with wheels or casters not blocked to provide a minimum of 3/4-inch clearance between wheels or casters and the base of the container.
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.4 **Tests.**

4.4.1 *Performance test for casters and wheels.* A force of sufficient intensity to move the safe a distance of not less than 20 feet across a level floor shall be applied to each side of the safe respectively. During and after the above test, the casters or wheels of the safe shall be examined to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.4.

4.4.2 *Finish test.* A steel panel, prepared in accordance with 3.6, shall be bent, at room temperature, around a 1/4-inch rod thru an angle 180 degrees. The coating shall then be examined to determine compliance with the requirement specified in 3.6.2.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of preservation, packaging, and packing for civil agency procurements.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified. (See 6.2.)

5.1.1 *Level A.*

5.1.1.1 *Preservation.* Each safe shall be provided with a humidity indicator and an activated desiccant, in accordance with formula II of MIL-P-116, except that the quantity of desiccant shall be increased by 60 percent to compensate for moisture contained in the insulation. The desiccant shall be distributed evenly throughout the interior of the safe.

5.1.1.2 *Packaging.* All drawers, adjustable shelves, vertical partitions, or other interior components shall be secured in position or wrapped, cushioned, and secured within the safe to prevent movement during transit. When drawers are provided with locks, they shall be locked, and their respective keys placed in a kraft-paper envelope. The envelope shall be taped to the drawer with minimum 2-inch-width tape conforming to type 1, class 1, of PPP-T-60. Instructions for the opening and changing of the combination shall be packaged method IC-1 of MIL-P-116, and secured to the door of the safe with tape specified herein. All openings into the safe including the dial mechanism shall be sealed with tape specified herein, and the exposed surfaces of the tape coated with varnish conforming to MIL-V-13811. Each safe shall be wrapped top and four sides with 60-pound basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade A of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be secured with tape specified herein.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Each safe shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the industry's practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified. (See 6.2.)

5.2.1 *Level A.* Each safe, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to type I, class 1 or 2, style a of MIL-C-104. The safe shall be anchored, blocked and braced in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. Each safe provided with wheels or casters shall be blocked to provide a minimum of 3/4-inch clearance between wheels or casters and the base of the container.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Each safe, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to style B, class 1 of MIL-C-132. Anchoring, blocking, bracing, and cushioning shall be as specified in 5.2.1.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Each safe, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The safes covered by this specification are intended for use in storing and in safeguarding from fire: Records, documents, and items of low monetary value. These safes are not intended to be used for the safeguarding of securities or items of any great monetary value.

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6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Class and style required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Size required (see 1.2.1.1).
(d) Interior arrangement required (see 1.2.2).
(e) When preproduction sample is not required (see 3.1).
(f) Whether hand-change or key-change combination lock are required (see 3.5.2).
(g) Whether safe shall be equipped with wheels, casters, or solid base (see 3.5.4).
(h) When color of finish other than gray is required (see 3.6.3).
(i) Marking requirements (see 3.9).
(j) Inspection record details (see 4.1).
(k) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 *Bidders must furnish* with each bid, the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. certification or labels called for under sub-paragraphs 3.4, 3.5.1, 3.5.2, and 3.5.3 of this specification in order to qualify as a responsible bidder and thus have his bid considered. The Government reserves the right, however, to test each sample safe, including all component parts thereof submitted prior to award of contract, and each safe, including all component parts thereof, delivered after award of contract for compliance with each requirement of this specification.

6.4 **Commercially available sizes.** The following is a table of commercially available safes. The sizes shown are for information purposes only and are not intended to restrict procurement of other sizes that may be required.

6.5 **Standard Pack (civil agencies).** For level B shipments, level A packaging and level B packing requirements should be specified. (See 5.1.1 and 5.2.2.) These requirements are intended for use in procurements of Stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the Standard Pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipping from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or immediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, and/or shipment to eventual user.

TABLE I.—*Commercial available sizes*

Size and class	Dimensions in inches[1]					
	Height		Width		Depth	
	Outside[2]	Inside	Outside[2]	Inside	Outside[2]	Inside
Small — Class-B	41-1/2	32	23-1/2	17	29	20
Small — Class-B or C	41-1/2	32	23-1/2	17	24	17
Medium — Class-A	64-1/2	50	30	20	31	19
Medium — Class-B	61-1/2	50	26	20	29	19
Medium — Class-C	58-1/2	50	25-1/2	20	27	19
Large — Class-A	66	50	44-7/8	32	31	19
Large — Class-B	62-1/2	50	41	32	29	19
Large — Class-C	60-1/2	50	40	32	29	19

[1] Dimensions have a tolerance of plus or minus 2 inches.
[2] Outside dimensions include hardware extension.

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6.6 Transportation description. Transportation description and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

RAIL:

Safes, fire or burglar proof. (Specify hollow walls or solid walls, 1 inch thick or more).
Carload minimum weights 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification or 30,000 pounds.

MOTOR:

Safes, fire or burglar proof (Specify hollow walls or solid walls, 1 inch thick or more).
Truckload minimum weights 24,000 or 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, National Motor Freight classification.

6.7 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades and sizes of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, et cetera, which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:
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